

Sunday, 12 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

30° 18°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

29° 17°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

28° 18°

GLASGOW

Overcast

20° 15°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **Very sad news as veteran TV presenter Dermot Murnaghan has died at the age of 68, following a battle with prostate cancer.**

Dermot was a familiar face on our screens for decades, having worked as a journalist and presenter for the BBC, ITV, and Sky News. He had previously revealed he was suffering from stage four prostate cancer.

OBITUARY · UK

- 2 **Get ready for another week of sunshine and soaring temperatures, as the heatwave looks set to continue across the UK.**

While some parts of the country might see a slight dip in temperatures this weekend, forecasters say the sizzling heat will stretch into next week. Perfect weather for those staycations!

WEATHER · UK

- 3 **A man suspected of a triple murder in the UK has been arrested in South Africa, following a major international manhunt.**

Prosecutors in the UK have now authorised charges against Ndodana Mkhanyisi Tshuma. This marks a significant development in a case that has gripped the nation.

CRIME · UK

- 4 **Health officials are urging people in their 50s to complete their bowel cancer screening, as uptake remains concerningly low.**

Little over half of 54-year-olds have completed the free at-home test kits, prompting fears that serious conditions could be missed. Early detection is crucial for successful treatment.

HEALTH · UK

- 5 **Good news for football fans! Pubs will be allowed to stay open for the entire England vs Norway game, even if kick-off is delayed.**

This means supporters won't miss a single minute of the action, even if there are any last-minute scheduling changes. It's all about making sure fans can enjoy the match.

FOOTBALL · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Sam Fender and Olivia Dean have made UK chart history with their collaboration 'Rein Me In', breaking a significant record!**

Their single has become the longest-running number one of all time by a British act. It's a huge achievement for both artists and a testament to the song's popularity.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Sam Fender or Olivia Dean track? Or perhaps another record-breaking song you love?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK
- 2 It's been twenty years since Snow Patrol released their iconic hit 'Chasing Cars', and the band are looking back at its incredible journey.**

They describe it as 'the song that took us to the whole world' and are also talking about their new single, which features Kylie Minogue. It's not a duet, though, they say!

ON AIR – What's your all-time favourite Snow Patrol song, and what makes it special to you?

MUSIC · ANNIVERSARY
- 3 Mr. Worldwide has done it again! Pitbull fans have set a Guinness World Record at his BST Hyde Park show.**

A whopping 22,000 fans donned bald caps, creating the largest gathering of people wearing them. Only Pitbull could inspire such dedication!

ON AIR – Would you ever wear a bald cap for your favourite artist? What's the most unusual thing you've done for a concert?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK
- 4 A YouTube sensation is making the leap to the big screen, as 'The Amazing Digital Circus' hits cinemas across the country.**

Fans actually emailed cinema chains asking them to show it, proving the power of online communities! It's an exciting time for digital creators.

ON AIR – Have you seen 'The Amazing Digital Circus' online? What other YouTube hits would you love to see in cinemas?

FILM · COMING UP
- 5 Paris Haute Couture Week 2026 has just wrapped up, showcasing all the latest and most extravagant fashion trends.**

Despite scorching temperatures in the French capital, designers unveiled their hottest collections. It's always a spectacle of creativity and glamour.

ON AIR – What's your take on haute couture – is it art or just unwearable fashion? What's the most outlandish outfit you've ever seen?

FASHION · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

1 **England are heading into uncharted territory at the World Cup, facing Norway in searing Miami temperatures.**

The Three Lions will have to contend with the heat, which could give Norway an edge. It's a real test of endurance for our squad.

ON AIR – Do you think playing in extreme heat gives one team a definite advantage? How do you think England will cope?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Huge congratulations to British duo Alfie Hewett and Gordon Reid, who have won their seventh Wimbledon men's wheelchair doubles title!**

They beat Gustavo Fernandez and Tokito Oda in a thrilling final. It's an incredible achievement and a testament to their enduring partnership.

ON AIR – What makes a great sporting partnership, in your opinion? Is it skill, chemistry, or something else?

TENNIS · UK

3 **History has been made at Lord's! India seamer Kranti Gaud has taken five wickets to become the first woman on the Test honours board.**

It's a truly glorious moment for Gaud and a landmark achievement in women's cricket. She'll be remembered in the sport's history books.

ON AIR – What's your favourite memory of watching cricket at Lord's, or any other iconic sporting venue?

CRICKET · UK

4 **Sad news from the football world, as former Chelsea and Leeds United owner Ken Bates has died at the age of 94.**

Chelsea Football Club announced the passing of the well-known and often controversial figure on Saturday. He certainly left his mark on both clubs.

ON AIR – What are your memories of Ken Bates' time at Chelsea or Leeds? He was certainly a character, wasn't he?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Good news for football fans! Pubs will be allowed to stay open for the entire England vs Norway game, even if kick-off is delayed.**

This means supporters won't miss a single minute of the action, even if there are any last-minute scheduling changes. It's all about making sure fans can enjoy the match.

ON AIR – Do you think extended pub hours for big games are a good idea? What's the best atmosphere you've experienced in a pub for a match?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new appreciation for 'vintage radio sets' is encouraging a return to simpler entertainment.**
Many are discovering the charm of listening to broadcasts on classic radios, valuing the quality of sound and the distraction-free experience.
- 2 The delightful trend of 'decorating garden gates' is adding character to neighbourhoods.**
From wreaths to small ornaments, people are personalising their gates, turning them into welcoming focal points.
- 3 The humble 'clothes peg' is being hailed as a surprisingly versatile household item beyond drying laundry.**
Inventive uses include keeping food bags sealed, organising cables, and even crafting.
- 4 A charming trend for 'collecting unusual shaped pebbles' is seeing a gentle resurgence.**
Beachcombers are carefully selecting stones that resemble hearts, animals, or other unique forms, creating quirky displays.
- 5 Interest in 'identifying different types of garden birds' is encouraging more people to observe nature closer to home.**
Armed with binoculars and guidebooks, many are enjoying the peaceful pastime of birdwatching from their windows or gardens.
- 6 A recent study suggests that the simple act of 'doodling during meetings' can actually improve memory retention.**
Far from being a sign of inattention, those who doodle often recall more information from discussions.
- 7 The comforting appeal of 'making homemade preserves' from local produce is flourishing.**
Jams, chutneys, and pickles are becoming popular gifts and a way to enjoy seasonal flavours all year round.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out how to put together flat-pack furniture, even though we know it won't help?

ANSWER: HUMMING A LITTLE TUNE WHILE SCRUTINISING THE INSTRUCTIONS, AS IF IT SOMEHOW MAKES THEM CLEARER!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'mug' that they absolutely have to use for their first cup of tea or coffee in the morning. What's so special about it?

ANSWER: IT'S THE ONLY ONE THAT FEELS 'JUST RIGHT' IN THEIR HANDS, OR IT HAS A SENTIMENTAL VALUE FROM A HOLIDAY OR GIFT.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you rediscover an 'old family recipe book' with handwritten notes and perhaps a few food stains, and it brings back a flood of memories?

What's the most treasured recipe or food memory that's been passed down in your family?

- We all have those 'little quirks' when it comes to how we organise our bookshelves – perhaps by colour, author, or a very particular way the paperbacks face?

What's your unique system for arranging your books, and why do you do it that way?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that the 'smell of rain' has its own scientific name? It's called petrichor.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Apparently, a group of squirrels is collectively known as a 'scurry' only when they are actively burying nuts.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£32 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£32 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's first public park was Birkenhead Park in Merseyside, which opened in 1847.
- A newborn giant panda is smaller than a mouse.
- The British Isles are home to over 20 species of bats.
- Pineapples were once so rare and expensive in Europe that they were rented as centrepieces for dinner parties.
- The 'skip' button on a remote control was first introduced on a VCR in the early 1980s.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth and can be seen from outer space.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The first ever Ferris wheel was built in Chicago in 1893 for the World's Columbian Exposition.

On this day

Day 193 of the year, 172 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Feast of Saints Peter and Paul (Eastern Orthodox); Christian feast day: Hermagoras and Fortunatus; Christian feast day: Jason of Thessalonica (Catholic Church); Christian feast day: John Gualbert. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1967 — Mac McCaughan, American singer and guitarist
- 1972 — Jake Wood, English actor
- 1984 — Natalie Martinez, American actress
- 1956 — Mel Harris, American actress
- 1964 — Gaby Roslin, English television host and actress
- 1980 — Kristen Connolly, American actress
- 1969 — Alan Mullally, English cricketer and sportscaster
- 1976 — Tracie Spencer, American singer-songwriter and actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1961 — Indian city Pune floods due to failure of the Khadakwasla and Panshet dams, killing at least two thousand people.
- 1995 — Chinese seismologists successfully predict the 1995 Myanmar–China earthquake, reducing the number of casualties to 11.
- 1913 — Serbian forces begin their siege of the Bulgarian city of Vidin; the siege is later called off when the war ends.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1960 — Orlyonok, the main Young Pioneer camp of the Russian SFSR, is founded.
- 1998 — France win their first World Cup title, defeating defending champions Brazil 3–0.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1917 — The Bisbee Deportation occurs as vigilantes kidnap and deport nearly 1,300 striking miners and others from Bisbee, Arizona.
- 1913 — Serbian forces begin their siege of the Bulgarian city of Vidin; the siege is later called off when the war ends.

- 1918 — The Imperial Japanese Navy battleship Kawachi blows up at Shunan, western Honshu, Japan, killing at least 621.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 194 of the year, 171 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abd-al-Masih; Christian feast day: Abel of Tacla Haimonot (Coptic Church); Christian feast day: Clelia Barbieri; Christian feast day: Conrad Weiser (Episcopal Church (USA)). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1989 — Leon Bridges, American soul singer, songwriter and record producer
- 2003 — Wyatt Oleff, American actor
- 1956 — Mark Mendoza, American bass player and songwriter
- 1940 — Patrick Stewart, English actor, director, and producer
- 1993 — Dan Bentley, English footballer
- 1946 — Cheech Marin, American actor and comedian
- 1928 — Bob Crane, American actor (died 1978)
- 1942 — Roger McGuinn, American singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2020 — After a five-day search, the body of American actress and singer Naya Rivera is recovered from Lake Piru in California, where she had drowned.
- 1951 — Vuoristorata, one of the oldest still-operating wooden roller coasters in Europe, is opened at the Linnanmäki amusement park in Helsinki, Finland.
- 2011 — Mumbai is rocked by three bomb blasts during the evening rush hour, killing 26 and injuring 130.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2016 — Prime Minister of the United Kingdom David Cameron resigns, and is succeeded by Theresa May.
- 2011 — Mumbai is rocked by three bomb blasts during the evening rush hour, killing 26 and injuring 130.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)